Grammar

Modals

We have already learnt about Modals in Class IX. Now, let us revise.

A modal verb is used to indicate modality (that expresses a speaker's general intention) i.e. likelihood, ability, permission, request, capacity, suggestions, order, obligation, advice etc.

We use modals to show if we believe something is certain, probable or possible.

Modals are,

can, could, may, might, will, would, shall, should, must & have to.

Semi/Quasi modals are,

ought to, need, dare & used to.

DO YOU KNOW? Modals do not change with the person or number of the subject.

A. Complete these sentences using appropriate modals. The clues in the brackets will help you.

1. When I was a child, I _____ climb trees easily but now I can't. *(ability in the past)*
2. I _____ win this singing contest. *(determination)*
3. You _____ buy this book. It is worth buying. *(advice or suggestion)*
4. Poongothai _____ speak several languages. *(ability in the present)*
5. I swear I _____ tell lies again. *(promise)*
6. My father _____ play badminton in the evenings when he was at college. *(past habit)*
7. You _____ do as I say! *(command)*
8. _____ I have another glass of water? *(request)*
9. Sibi has not practised hard but he _____ win the race. *(possibility)*
10. We _____ preserve our natural resources. *(duty)*

B. Rewrite the following sentences by rectifying the errors in the use of modals.

1. Would I have your autograph?
2. I can be fifteen next April.
3. Take an umbrella. It should rain later.
4. The magistrate ordered that he might pay the fine.
5. Make me a cup of tea, shall you?
6. You may speak politely to the elders.
7. You will get your teeth cleaned at least once a year.
8. We could grow vegetables in our kitchen garden but we don't do it now.
9. Must I get your jacket? The weather is cold.
10. Could the train be on time?

C. Read the dialogue and fill in the blanks with suitable modals.

Dad: _____ we go out for dinner tonight?

Charan: Yes, Dad. We _____ go to a restaurant where I _____ have some ice cream.

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